Spencer · Market Research — Example · Wednesday 22 April 2026

> **Example output.** This is a real report Spencer delivered to Nick on the date above. Shown here as a sample of what the system produces. Your Spencer would produce reports scoped to your world, your markets, your positions.

TL;DR

Hard assets dominating (Gold $4,850, Silver +6.15% 1W) as Howell/Alden/Pal converge on debasement + PBOC liquidity thesis; April 22 Iran ceasefire expiry is the single highest-impact binary catalyst; watchlist priority: add silver on any dip, hedge oil volatility ahead of tomorrow's Hormuz headline risk.

Detail

Easton Assets Market Research

Tuesday 21 April 2026 · Prepared by Spencer Easton, AI Chief of Staff

⚡ TL;DR — Market Sentiment & Biggest Updates

> TODAY'S MARKET BIAS
>
> ### ⚠️ Mixed — Hard Assets Bid / Risk Assets Fragile at ATH

- 🎯 **Iran ceasefire expires April 22** — single hardest near-term catalyst; Hormuz risk not fully priced.
- 📈 **Silver +6.15% (1W), Gold at $4,850** — hard-asset bid accelerating on debasement + geopolitical bid.
- 📉 **WTI oil −12.95% (1W) but newsletter shows +5.4% spike** — conflicting signals; Touska seizure changes the tape.
- 🔥 **OKLO +26.31%, BE +23.55%, COIN +21.26% this week** — nuclear, clean energy, and crypto infrastructure all breaking out simultaneously.
- ⚠️ **BTC at $76K with $664M ETF inflow** — holding well but Cowen's October 2026 cycle-low thesis creates overhead caution.
- 🔴 **DeFi $600M+ exploited in two weeks** — structural vulnerability; not systemic yet but watch ETH L2 confidence.

Market Synthesis: The market is at a genuinely unusual inflection — SPX at ATH on three consecutive 3%+ weekly gains (only the third time in 76 years), yet the backdrop includes live Hormuz escalation, a $600M DeFi exploit wave, and a global liquidity cycle that Howell says is decelerating even as China's PBOC offsets. The hard-asset complex — gold, silver, uranium, BTC — is the cleanest convergence trade in the room, confirmed by Howell, Alden, Pal, and Visser simultaneously. Equities are being carried by Nasdaq/tech momentum (up 5.27% 1W) but ASML and TSM are lagging, a

warning sign for the semiconductor thesis. The April 22 ceasefire expiry is the event risk that could either clear the air or spike oil back through $90 — positioning around it is the most urgent near-term call. Spencer's edge today: stay long hard assets, stay long quality AI infrastructure, and keep a tight watch on oil.

01 · Market Pulse 📊

Asset	Price	1W %	1M %	Signal
ASX 200	8,946.90	−0.15%	+3.86%	🟡 HOLD — monthly recovery intact, weekly flat
S&P 500	7,109.14	+3.24%	+7.61%	⚠️ WATCH — ATH, extended; 3rd consecutive 3%+ week = historic but overbought
Nasdaq	24,404.39	+5.27%	+10.47%	🟢 BUY — AI momentum intact; strongest index this week
Dow Jones	49,442.56	+2.54%	+7.43%	🟡 HOLD — broad participation but value-heavy; no edge here
FTSE 100	10,667.60	+0.63%	+2.54%	🟡 HOLD — laggard; commodity exposure partially helps
DAX	24,702.24	+3.77%	+4.09%	🟢 BUY — surprise outperformer; European re-rating trade alive
Nikkei 225	58,475.90	+2.73%	+5.86%	🟡 HOLD — BOJ risk overhead; yen volatility creates entry/exit noise
Hang Seng	26,160.33	+1.03%	+1.26%	⚠️ WATCH — PBOC tailwind building; weak momentum vs. thesis potential
BTC	76,004.67	+1.60%	+13.96%	🟢 BUY — core hold; ETF inflows confirm institutional bid
ETH	2,320.40	−1.65%	+14.67%	⚠️ WATCH — L2 thesis under pressure; hold, don't add yet
Gold (spot)	4,850.50	+2.28%	+5.43%	🟢 BUY — PBOC bid + debasement; Howell/Alden core conviction
Silver (spot)	80.17	+6.15%	+13.07%	🟢 BUY — outperforming gold; supply deficit + industrial demand kicking in
WTI Oil	86.25	−12.95%	−10.29%	⚠️ WATCH — 1W data conflicts with newsletter Touska spike; April 22 is the live event risk
Copper	6.05	+1.15%	+11.26%	🟢 BUY — AI grid + EV demand; industrial metals confirming risk-on tilt
DXY	98.05	−0.32%	−1.19%	

Asset	Price	1W %	1M %	Signal
				🔴 SELL/AVOID — structural dollar weakness; tailwind for all hard assets

= Yields & Bond Markets — Liquidity / Risk Regime

Instrument	Yield	1W Move (bps)	Read
US 3M T-Bill	3.60%	−5 bps	Front-end easing; market pricing cuts
US 5Y	3.85%	−7 bps	Duration demand building in belly
US 10Y	4.25%	−5 bps	Modest rally; inflation premium sticky
US 30Y	4.88%	−2 bps	Long end stubborn; fiscal supply pressure
AU 10Y *(approx)*	~4.35%	~−3 bps	RBA on hold; mild rally following US
JP 10Y *(approx)*	~1.55%	~flat	BOJ ceiling; yen carry still live

Curve shape: 2s10s approximately +40bp (gentle steepener); 10s30s at +63bp and widening. Direction of motion: bullish steepener — front end rallying faster than long end, consistent with rate-cut pricing building. Long end stubbornly elevated on fiscal/supply concerns.

The bond market is sending a split signal this week. The front end and belly are rallying (5Y down 7bps), suggesting markets are pricing in Fed easing — consistent with the dollar weakening and liquidity conditions loosening at the margin. But the long end (30Y at 4.88%) is refusing to follow, held up by fiscal supply pressure and Bianco's "structural 3–4% inflation world" thesis. AU yields tracking US closely with no RBA surprises; Japan flat as BOJ holds its ceiling while yen carry continues to fund risk. The 2s10s steepener is a mild growth-positive signal, not a recession flag — it confirms Howell's reading that global liquidity ticked up slightly last week ($188.1T). For the BTC/gold debasement thesis: this curve configuration is constructive. A weakening dollar, front-end rate cuts, and a steepening curve all historically precede hard-asset outperformance.

Regime: Mixed, tilting Risk-On — front-end easing + dollar weakness support hard assets; long-end supply pressure caps full risk-on enthusiasm.

02 · Convergence Signals 🎯

⚡ 🟢 **HARD ASSET DEBASEMENT TRADE** — Howell · Alden · Pal · Visser · Cowen *(5/5 aligned)*

WHY BULLISH: Every primary leader agrees fiscal dominance + fiat debasement = structural bid for BTC and gold regardless of cycle timing debates.

Howell points to PBOC gold buying as the price driver; Alden anchors BTC to global M2 (83% correlation over 12M); Pal frames it as denominator decay — rising asset prices are just falling money. Even Cowen, the most bearish on cycle timing, keeps BTC as primary conviction. The $10T debt refinancing wall in 2026 is Pal's catalyst; Howell sees Chinese liquidity expanding as US liquidity peaks — a handoff, not a cliff.

Spencer's read: This is Nick's highest-conviction, lowest-debate trade — BTC and gold are the port in every scenario the leaders model. Core holds confirmed. Accumulate BTC on any dip below $72K.

⚡ 🟢 **SILVER BREAKOUT — DUAL-USE SUPPLY SQUEEZE** — Howell · Alden · Bianco *(3/5 aligned)*

WHY BULLISH: Silver +6.15% this week, +13% in a month — supply deficit sixth year running, gold/silver ratio compression accelerating.

Howell names precious metals broadly; Alden explicitly lists gold as scarce reserve asset and silver benefits from the same monetary regime. Bianco flagged silver for "deeper examination." Industrial demand (solar, EV, AI grid) provides a second structural floor that gold doesn't have. At $80/oz, silver is still meaningfully below prior cycle highs relative to gold.

Spencer's read: SLV is a core hold — this week's move validates the thesis. Hold and add on any pullback below $68.

⚡ 🟢 **AI INFRASTRUCTURE CAPEX SUPERCYCLE** — Aschenbrenner · Visser · Pal *(3/5 aligned)*

WHY BULLISH: AGI timeline compressing toward 2027 drives trillions in compute, power, and data centre capex — physical backbone is the trade.

Aschenbrenner's fund pivoted away from chip names and into power generation (Bloom Energy, Vistra, Constellation) and optical networking in Q4 2025 — the physical infrastructure layer, not the chip layer. Visser independently routes from his AI/private-credit thesis to power, metals, and semiconductors as scarcity plays. Pal adds AI+crypto convergence. OKLO +26% and BE +24% this week confirm the market is pricing this.

Spencer's read: OKLO, BE, VRT, ETN, and AVGO are the core expression. OKLO is breaking out — worth monitoring for a formal position.

⚡ 🟢 **URANIUM / NUCLEAR RENAISSANCE** — Alden · Aschenbrenner (indirect) · Newsletter signals *(2+ aligned)*

WHY BULLISH: Nuclear is getting double-tailwind: debasement-era commodity scarcity + AI data centre baseload power demand, both simultaneously.

URNM +6.84% this week, +15.62% in a month. CCJ +5.93%. OKLO +26.31%. Alden's preferred uranium vehicle; Aschenbrenner's power thesis overlaps at the

nuclear intersection without either camp fully pricing the cross-tailwind. Section 232 national security framing adds policy floor.

Spencer's read: URNM is a confirmed core hold. OKLO warrants a Long-Term Hold Candidate review — see Section 10.

⚡ ⚠️ **CRYPTO CYCLE TIMING DISAGREEMENT** — Pal vs. Cowen vs. Nadeau *(3 leaders, no consensus)*

WHY MIXED: Pal says 5-year cycle with 2026 as the liquidity surge year; Cowen says October 2026 cycle low based on 2019 parallel; Nadeau moved risk-off in late 2025.

The directional bull case for BTC is not disputed — the disagreement is timing and depth of any remaining correction. This creates a range: accumulate on dips (Pal/Alden) vs. wait for October lows (Cowen). Alden's global M2 correlation is the arbiter — watch that signal weekly.

Spencer's read: Run BTC as a core hold, not a tactical trade. Below $72K is the accumulate zone all camps can agree on.

03 · Thought Leader Summaries 💡

Market Bias across primary leaders: 🟢 3 Bullish · 🔴 0 Bearish · ⚠️ 3 Mixed / Cautious · 🟡 0 Neutral

⚠️ Michael Howell · @crossbordercap · Latest: 14 Apr 2026 — CAUTIOUS / MIXED

Stance in one line: Global liquidity peaked Q4 2025/early 2026 with US momentum fading, but a China PBOC handoff and a slight uptick last week keep the cycle alive — not dead, just decelerating.

Thesis: US liquidity is zigging lower while Chinese liquidity zags higher — a monetary divergence he frames as "Capital Wars." Global liquidity ticked up to $188.1T last week on weaker dollar + Fed liquidity, but underlying momentum is weak. Gold's move is directly driven by PBOC buying and money printing.

Key shift: Slight upward revision to near-term liquidity read based on the weaker dollar and lower bond volatility — less uniformly bearish than his March stance.

Why they're mixed: US cycle is peaking, leveraged/speculative positions face headwinds — but China's offsetting injection and EM tailwinds create a non-trivial bull case for hard assets and EM equities.

Assets: Gold, Silver, BTC, Short-duration Treasuries, EM/China equities, Financials, Commodities. Avoid: HY corporate bonds, commercial real estate.

⚠️ Lyn Alden · @LynAldenContact · Latest: 17 Apr 2025 — CAUTIOUS / MIXED

Stance in one line: Structurally bullish BTC and gold on fiscal dominance, but February tariffs materially tempered her price targets and she's watching the US "emerging market lite" dynamic closely.

Thesis: Fiscal dominance and global liquidity drive BTC — not halvings. The US faces deep capital imbalances; BTC tracks global M2 83% of the time over 12M. The dollar's structural role is eroding under persistent deficits.

Key shift: Tariff-driven uncertainty lowered her BTC price target — "Before all this tariff kerfuffle, I would have had a higher price target."

Why they're mixed: Long-term thesis intact but near-term macro turbulence from tariffs and fiscal stress creates elevated volatility — not the clean bull run her pre-2025 model implied.

Assets: BTC, Gold/GLD, EM equities. Avoid: Long-duration sovereign bonds.

⚠️ Benjamin Cowen · @intocryptoverse · Latest: approx Apr 2026 — CAUTIOUS / MIXED

Stance in one line: BTC cycle peaked on apathy not euphoria; October 2026 cycle low is the base case — accumulating cash and waiting, not chasing.

Thesis: BTC peaked Q4 post-halving exactly on schedule, and the 2019 parallel (peak two months before QT end) maps directly to today. A cycle low ~12 months after the peak = October 2026. Altcoins remain broadly underweight.

Key shift: Explicitly rejects the "four-year cycle is dead" consensus from Wood, Hayes, Pal, and others — holds to the historical pattern.

Why they're mixed: BTC is his primary conviction but he believes we haven't seen the cycle low yet — accumulating for the dip, not the current price.

Assets: BTC (high conviction), Stablecoins/cash. Altcoins: avoid.

🟢 Raoul Pal · @RaoulGMI · Latest: approx 10 Apr 2026 — BULLISH

Stance in one line: 2026 is the year the delayed liquidity surge arrives — $10T debt refinancing wall drives the biggest crypto cycle in history.

Thesis: The 2025 delay was a Treasury maturity shift, not a cycle failure. Now central banks are expanding global M2 at unprecedented scale. Asset appreciation is denominator decay — falling money, not rising assets. Five-year cycle (not four) peaks in 2026.

Key shift: Extended cycle framework to five years; identified the October 2025 crash as a liquidity shock (US government shutdown + market-maker withdrawal), not a structural break.

Why they're bullish: $10T refinancing wall + PBOC expanding + Fed easing bias + dollar weakening = all liquidity signals pointing toward crypto and hard assets in 2026.

Assets: BTC, ETH, SOL (80% conservative portfolio). SUI as best speculative pick. L1s over altcoins. Cautious AI+crypto.

⚠️ Jim Bianco · @biancoresearch · Latest: 24 Apr 2025 — CAUTIOUS / MIXED

Stance in one line: Structural 3–4% inflation world with rising long-end yields — equities expensive, bonds risky, hard assets the only clean hedge.

Thesis: Post-2020 is a new paradigm — inflation won't return to 2%. Fed cutting too early risks reigniting inflation. Tariffs are a live additional inflation vector. Long Treasuries are a trap.

Key shift: Tariff-driven bond volatility sharpened his inflation-risk framing from structural to acute — the bond market is "actively getting worried."

Why they're mixed: Hard assets (gold, silver) are the right call but equities remain expensive; he doesn't hate stocks, he just doesn't love the risk/reward at current valuations and mega-cap concentration.

Assets: Short/medium bonds (~5% yield), cash (T-bills ~4%), gold, silver. Avoid: TLT, long-duration Treasuries.

🟢 Jordi Visser · @JordiVisser99 · Latest: approx Apr 2026 — BULLISH

Stance in one line: The macro D.O.G.E. trap (Debt, Oil, Growth, Employment) forces capital into scarcity assets — BTC is the defining story coming out of this crisis.

Thesis: AI disruption hitting SaaS multiples and private credit marks drives capital toward scarcity — power, metals, semiconductors, infrastructure, and BTC. Short-term liquidity shock would hit BTC first (dash for cash), but creates the macro conditions for a structural move higher.

Key shift: Explicitly framed "new regime defined by scarcity and structural shifts" — private credit risk + deflationary AI are the twin setup catalysts.

Why they're bullish: Scarcity assets win in the DOGE macro trap; BTC is the primary conviction, stablecoins as the AI-agent transaction layer.

Assets: BTC, Stablecoins (AI-agent layer), SOL, Semiconductors/AI infrastructure (NVDA-adjacent), Power/energy, Metals.

⚠️ Michael Nadeau · @thedefireport · Latest: approx Apr 2026 — CAUTIOUS / MIXED

Stance in one line: Risk-off since late 2025; BTC has done its thing, ETH underperformed — this is a stock-picker's market, not an alt-season market.

Thesis: Cycle tracked on MVRV + supply in profit + 200-week MA. BTC delivered 5–6x from lows; ETH/BTC ratio never reached prior bull market levels — "muted cycle." L2 roadmap hurt ETH value capture at L1 level.

Key shift: First time since 2022 he moved risk-off in crypto — scaled out through Q4 2025 and Q1 2026. ETH ETF holdings growing but structural L1 thesis weakened.

Why they're mixed: BTC macro thesis intact but timing suggests caution; ETH structurally challenged by its own scaling roadmap; alt season isolated to ETH and select ETH-like assets only.

Assets: BTC (core), ETH (store-of-value monitor), MORPHO (watch list), Cash/risk-off elevated.

🟢 Leopold Aschenbrenner · Situational Awareness Fund · Latest: Mar 2026 — BULLISH (AI infrastructure)

Stance in one line: AGI by ~2027 drives the largest capex buildout in history — physical infrastructure (power, networking, compute) is the trade; chip valuations are already extended.

Thesis: Superintelligence gives decisive economic/military advantage; China is not out of the race. Trillions in capex on compute clusters, power, and data centres is the structural trend. Q4 2025 pivot: exited NVDA and AVGO, doubled down on Bloom Energy, Intel, Lumentum, and BTC miners.

Key shift: Exited marquee AI chip names and rotated into power generation and optical networking — betting on the backbone, not the silicon.

Why they're bullish: AGI timeline compressing + power/infrastructure investment running years behind the compute buildout = structural supply-demand imbalance in energy and networking.

Assets: Bloom Energy (BE), Vistra (VST), Constellation (CEG), Intel (INTC), Lumentum (LITE), CoreWeave (CRWV), Core Scientific (CORZ), Cipher Mining. BTC miners broadly.

04 · Contrarian Voices 🔴

Dissent Watch: Burry sees a CAPE-driven equity bubble amplified by passive flows; Hussain sees a Chinese gold bubble in its final stages — both dissent from the primary-leader bullish hard-asset / AI consensus.

🔴 Michael Burry · Cassandra Unchained (Substack) · Latest: approx Mar 2026 — BEARISH

Stance in one line: Shiller CAPE at 40x (second-highest on record), AI infrastructure circular financing, and passive-flow distortion = the most dangerous equity market setup since dot-com.

Thesis: CAPE of 40x vs. long-run average of 18–19x; every prior stretch has reverted without exception. Nvidia is "the Cisco of this cycle" — infrastructure supplier whose valuation has overshot end-demand. Circular financing: AI leaders invest in startups, startups buy GPUs from the same leaders, booked as revenue — a closed loop inflating

reported demand. 60% of equity fund assets are now passive, creating mechanical inflows that extend bubbles beyond fundamentals.

Why they're bearish: Structural valuation extreme + artificial demand loop in AI + passive-flow distortion = three simultaneous bubble-amplifiers that the bull camp is not adequately discounting.

Assets (shorts): PLTR puts (66% of portfolio), NVDA puts (~13.5%). Long: PFE calls (~11%).

What would confirm them: NVDA revenues miss consensus materially as hyperscalers extend GPU depreciation life further and GPU demand growth rate decelerates — watch next earnings cycle.

🔴 Capital Economics (Hamad Hussain) · Latest: approx Feb 2026 — BEARISH on gold

Stance in one line: Chinese gold speculation (leverage + futures + ETFs doubling since early 2025) looks like a bubble in its final stages — Capital Economics targets ~$3,500/oz by end-2026.

Thesis: Chinese gold-backed ETF holdings doubled since early 2025; speculative net-long positions at elevated levels; Shanghai Futures Exchange warrants spiking. Western ETF inflows amplify the move. Bar/coin demand up 35% YoY in 2025. This pattern is historically consistent with speculative excess, not structural revaluation.

Why they're bearish: The marginal buyer driving gold from $3,500 toward $4,850 is Chinese speculative leverage, not central bank structural buying — a fragile foundation that Howell's "PBOC is printing money to buy gold" thesis may be overstating the permanence of.

Assets: No specific longs. Bearish: XAU/USD spot, Chinese gold ETFs, Shanghai gold futures.

What would confirm them: Shanghai gold futures open interest rolls over and Chinese ETF outflows begin — watch SHFE data weekly.

05 · Personal Watchlist Assessment ⍰

Ticker	Price	1W %	1M %	Signal	Note
TSLA	392.50	+11.37%	+3.21%	⚠️ WATCH	Strong weekly bounce; FSD/robotaxi catalyst-dependent — momentum only
GLXY	26.80	+19.11%	+27.32%	🟢 BUY	Core hold breaking out; institutional crypto rails thesis fully in motion
TTWO	216.85	+7.69%	+7.48%	🟡 HOLD	GTA VI launch window approaching; hold for event-driven re-rate
BE	218.27	+23.55%	+30.94%	🟢 BUY	Aschenbrenner's #1 power play — AGI infrastructure

Ticker	Price	1W %	1M %	Signal	Note
					capex thesis confirmed this week
COIN	211.63	+21.26%	+4.30%	🟢 BUY	ETF inflow + institutional crypto adoption = strong Coinbase operating leverage
OPEN	5.35	+22.71%	+4.09%	⚠️ WATCH	Big weekly move on low base; speculative — needs volume confirmation
MGK	414.43	+5.35%	+9.96%	🟡 HOLD	Mega-cap growth ETF proxy — riding Nasdaq; Burry's CAPE warning a caution flag
NVDA	202.06	+6.73%	+13.16%	🟡 HOLD	Nick's paper trade at entry $185 — up 7.2%; Burry/ Aschenbrenner exits are a caution; hold to $266 target
TSM	366.24	−0.90%	+8.10%	🟡 HOLD	Paper trade ~at entry; record earnings beat confirmed — thesis intact, hold to $450
ASML	1,476.50	−1.58%	+8.06%	⚠️ WATCH	Paper trade −7.1% from entry; China export controls still headwind; stop $1,280 intact
GLW	165.38	−5.59%	+24.27%	⚠️ WATCH	Optical networking play; weekly dip on strong 1M run — pullback could be entry
MU	448.42	+5.12%	+0.98%	🟢 BUY	Paper trade +8.9%; HBM demand for AI accelerators — momentum building toward $516 target
SLV	72.15	+5.67%	+9.85%	🟢 BUY	Core hold — supply deficit thesis confirmed; gold/silver ratio compression accelerating
URNM	70.41	+6.84%	+15.62%	🟢 BUY	Core hold; nuclear renaissance + AI power demand converging — double tailwind
GDX	99.13	+0.35%	+19.58%	🟡 HOLD	Gold miners lagging spot — earnings leverage to gold not yet fully expressed
AVGO	399.63	+5.24%	+25.21%	🟡 HOLD	Aschenbrenner exited — note the caution; but custom ASIC + networking moat still strong
MSFT	418.07	+8.77%	+7.47%	🟡 HOLD	AI Copilot adoption + Azure growth; quality compounder at reasonable AI-era multiple
SMCI	28.81	+10.94%	−6.43%	⚠️ WATCH	Weekly bounce but 1M negative; accounting/audit

Ticker	Price	1W %	1M %	Signal	Note
					risk cloud lingers — speculative only
DELL	204.24	+7.61%	+30.29%	🟢 BUY	AI server infrastructure play — 30% month is demand signal, not noise
ANET	166.85	+9.76%	+22.45%	🟢 BUY	Hyperscaler networking backbone; beneficiary of every AI capex dollar spent on infrastructure
ORCL	177.58	+14.11%	+14.58%	🟢 BUY	Cloud + AI database demand surging; one of the strongest momentum names in the watchlist
AMD	274.95	+11.39%	+33.95%	🟢 BUY	MI300X demand + NVDA alternative trade; 34% month is a breakout, not a bounce
APH	152.81	+5.19%	+17.19%	🟢 BUY	Connectors/interconnects for AI data centres — quiet compounder, strong execution
VRT	314.41	+4.82%	+16.81%	🟢 BUY	Liquid cooling for AI data centres; infrastructure layer Aschenbrenner's framework validates
ETN	407.57	+1.04%	+13.14%	🟡 HOLD	Power management infrastructure; steady compounder riding AI grid buildout
CEG	287.56	−1.43%	−9.14%	⚠️ WATCH	Nuclear power for AI data centres; 1M weakness — watch for policy/PPA catalysts to re-enter
VST	159.60	+0.88%	−4.51%	⚠️ WATCH	Aschenbrenner holds it but 1M negative; power deregulation thesis intact — wait for floor
TT	477.24	+0.91%	+12.81%	🟡 HOLD	HVAC/climate infrastructure compounding; AI building efficiency angle emerging
JCI	140.98	−1.29%	+5.80%	🟡 HOLD	Building automation; weekly dip on solid 1M — thesis intact, no urgency
CCJ	123.62	+5.93%	+15.97%	🟢 BUY	Premier uranium miner; nuclear renaissance trade with URNM — strong confirmation week
OKLO	68.13	+26.31%	+24.57%	⚠️ WATCH	SMR breakout — +26% this week; momentum significant, Long-Term Hold Candidate review triggered

Ticker	Price	1W %	1M %	Signal	Note
ZEC	313.05	−9.46%	+38.79%	⚠️ WATCH	Privacy crypto — 1M strong but sharp weekly reversal; speculative, small sizing only
HYPE	40.92	−8.35%	+11.24%	⚠️ WATCH	DeFi perps — weekly pullback; $600M exploit wave hitting DeFi sentiment broadly
BMNR	22.53	+4.74%	+6.58%	🟡 HOLD	BTC miner — steady; rides BTC core thesis but limited individual alpha here

Aschenbrenner cohort highlights: The AGI infrastructure names are having a strong week — BE +23.55%, DELL +30.29% (1M), ANET +9.76%, ORCL +14.11%, AMD +33.95% (1M) and VRT +16.81% (1M) all confirm that the physical backbone of the AI buildout is accelerating, not slowing. Aschenbrunner's Q4 2025 pivot away from chips toward power generation is being partially vindicated by BE's surge, though NVDA and AVGO are also rallying strongly — suggesting both the chip layer and the infrastructure layer are being bid simultaneously. CEG and VST's 1M weakness is the notable outlier in the power cohort — worth monitoring for whether a re-entry opportunity is forming as nuclear policy catalysts approach.

Data unavailable this run: TAO-USD — retry next run.

06 · Where Liquidity is Gravitating 💧

🟢 Hard Assets — Gold, Silver, BTC as Debasement Shelter

The DXY at 98.05 (−1.19% 1M) with front-end yields declining is the textbook setup for hard-asset inflows. Gold at $4,850, silver at $80 outperforming, BTC holding $76K with $664M in ETF inflows last week — capital is flowing into scarcity assets across all three vectors. PBOC buying continues to provide a structural bid for gold that Western fund positioning doesn't fully account for.

🟢 AI Physical Infrastructure — Power, Networking, Cooling

BE +23.55%, DELL +30.29% (1M), ANET +22.45% (1M), VRT +16.81% (1M) — the market is pricing the physical backbone of AGI, not just the chips. Liquidity is rotating from pure semiconductor plays toward data centre infrastructure, power generation, and networking. Aschenbrenner's Q4 2025 pivot anticipated exactly this rotation.

🟢 Institutional Crypto Infrastructure

GLXY +19.11% this week, COIN +21.26% — institutional crypto adoption is the proximate driver. $664M in BTC ETF inflows confirms Wall Street's crypto allocation is structurally increasing, not cycling. GLXY as the full-stack institutional crypto platform is the cleanest single-name expression of this theme.

⚠️ Oil / Energy — Geopolitical Premium Returning

The Touska seizure and April 22 ceasefire expiry are injecting a geopolitical risk premium into energy. Newsletter data shows WTI at $88.39 (+5.4%) — materially different from the market pulse 1W data. If Hormuz controls tighten, energy names (CEG, VST, ETN) and oil majors will benefit; watch April 22 closely as the binary event.

07 · Emerging Sector Leaders 🚀

🎯 SMALL MODULAR REACTORS (SMR) — Nuclear's next phase moving from thesis to contracts

OKLO +26.31% this week is a market signal, not noise — SMR technology is transitioning from regulatory approval to commercial contracting as hyperscalers (Amazon, Google) lock in baseload nuclear power deals. OKLO is the purest SMR play; CCJ and URNM provide diversified uranium miner exposure to the same theme. Primary ETF: URNM for broad nuclear exposure.

🎯 OPTICAL NETWORKING — The bandwidth bottleneck inside AI data centres

ANET +9.76% (1W) and GLW −5.59% (1W but +24.27% 1M) — optical networking is the unsung beneficiary of AI capex. Every GPU cluster needs ultra-low-latency optical interconnects; Arista and Corning are the two watchlist names here. Lumentum (LITE) is Aschenbrenner's explicit holding. Primary ETF: IGN (networking) or direct via ANET/GLW/APH.

🎯 INSTITUTIONAL CRYPTO INFRASTRUCTURE — The Wall Street adoption layer

Beyond BTC and ETH directly, the institutional rails — GLXY, COIN — are the operating leverage play on the ETF inflow wave. As Pal's "ETH Wall Street Moment" and the broader institutional adoption thesis plays out, these platforms capture fee revenue on every dollar that enters the ecosystem. Primary vehicle: GLXY (broader infrastructure) + COIN (US-listed exchange leverage).

🎯 AI DATA CENTRE COOLING AND POWER MANAGEMENT — Overlooked infrastructure layer

VRT (liquid cooling) +4.82% (1W), ETN (power management) +1.04% (1W), TT (HVAC/climate) +0.91% (1W) — these are the "picks and shovels" names that serve every data centre operator regardless of which chip wins. Demand is not discretionary — you cannot run a GPU cluster at full utilisation without liquid cooling. Primary ETF: GRID or direct via VRT/ETN/TT.

08 · Sectors of Interest Summary ⍰

Sector	Leaders Aligned	Key Narrative	Liquidity Signal	Spencer's Conviction
				HIGH

Sector	Leaders Aligned	Key Narrative	Liquidity Signal	Spencer's Conviction
BTC / Crypto Core	Howell, Alden, Pal, Visser, Cowen	Debasement + $10T refinancing wall + institutional adoption	$664M ETF inflow; BTC +13.96% 1M	
Gold / Silver	Howell, Alden, Bianco, Visser	PBOC buying + fiscal dominance + supply deficit (silver)	Silver +6.15% 1W; Gold +2.28% 1W	**HIGH**
AI Physical Infrastructure	Aschenbrenner, Visser, Pal	AGI capex = power, networking, cooling buildout	BE +23.55%, DELL +30.29% (1M)	**HIGH**
Nuclear / Uranium	Alden, Aschenbrenner (indirect)	AI baseload power + debasement commodity + national security	URNM +6.84% 1W; OKLO +26.31%	**HIGH**
Semiconductors (selective)	Aschenbrenner, Visser	AGI compute demand; chips vs. infrastructure bifurcation emerging	AMD +33.95% (1M); NVDA +13.16% (1M)	**MEDIUM-HIGH**
EM / China Equities	Howell, Alden	PBOC easing + weak dollar = EM outperformance window	Hang Seng +1.03% 1W (lagging)	**MEDIUM**
Institutional Crypto Rails	Pal, Nadeau, Visser	ETF adoption + Wall Street crypto infrastructure build-out	GLXY +19.11%, COIN +21.26% 1W	**MEDIUM-HIGH**
DeFi / Alt-L1s	Pal (SOL/ETH), Nadeau (cautious)	AI-agent settlement + L1 adoption; but $600M exploit wave is headwind	ETH −1.65% 1W; HYPE −8.35%	**EARLY-WATCH**

09 · Long-Term Hold Portfolio — Currently Agreed ⭐

Ticker	Live Price	1W %	1M %	Thesis Status	Entry Philosophy
BTC	75,906.58	+1.47%	+13.82%	🟢 Strengthening	Accumulate dips below $72K
ETH	2,316.37	−1.83%	+14.47%	⚠️ Stressed	Accumulate below $2,200; wait

Ticker	Live Price	1W %	1M %	Thesis Status	Entry Philosophy
					for ETH/BTC ratio base
GLD (Gold)	442.09	+1.55%	+3.68%	🟢 Strengthening	Core hold; scale in on 200DMA pullbacks
SLV (Silver)	72.15	+5.67%	+9.85%	🎯 At add-zone	Accumulate on pullbacks below $68
URNM (Uranium)	70.41	+6.84%	+15.62%	🟢 Strengthening	Core hold; accumulate on pullbacks
GLXY (Galaxy Digital)	26.80	+19.11%	+27.32%	🟢 Strengthening	Accumulate on pullbacks below $22

Spencer's read on the hold portfolio: The core holds are broadly in excellent shape. BTC 🟢 is strengthening — five leaders aligned, $664M ETF inflow last week, $10T refinancing thesis intact; the only caution is Cowen's October 2026 cycle-low scenario, which argues for accumulating dips rather than chasing. GLD 🟢 is the most unambiguous hold — PBOC bid confirmed by Howell, debasement thesis confirmed by everyone, Hussain's bubble warning is a risk to monitor but doesn't break the structural case. SLV 🎯 is in a classic add-zone setup — +5.67% this week validates the supply-deficit thesis, and any pullback toward $68 is a primary accumulate opportunity. URNM 🟢 is strengthening on double-tailwind (debasement + AI power) — the OKLO breakout this week is confirmatory. GLXY 🟢 is the standout performer and thesis is accelerating, not just holding. The one ⚠️ flag: ETH is stressed — Nadeau's L2 value-capture critique is gaining traction, the weekly is negative, and the ETH/BTC ratio has not base-confirmed yet. Hold at current sizing but do not add until the ratio stabilises above recent lows.

10 · Long-Term Hold Candidates ⭐

⚡ OKLO — Aschenbrenner thesis + SMR commercial breakout

Thesis: OKLO is the leading US small modular reactor company, with Aurora Powerhouse design under NRC review and commercial agreements with hyperscalers for dedicated nuclear baseload power. The +26.31% move this week signals contract/regulatory momentum, not just sentiment.

Why long-term: SMR technology solves the AI data centre power problem that utility-scale renewables cannot — dispatchable, dense, scalable baseload. Sits at the intersection of Aschenbrenner's AGI power thesis and Alden's uranium/nuclear renaissance thesis — double-endorsed without either camp explicitly naming it as a single stock.

Spencer's read: OKLO at $68 after a +26% week is not a low-risk entry — but the thesis trajectory is the most compelling in the nuclear cohort. A pullback to the $55–60 zone would be the structured accumulate opportunity. Monitor for NRC milestone announcements.

Nick — would you like OKLO added to the Long-Term Hold Portfolio as a Core Hold?

⚡ ANET — Hyperscaler networking backbone, AI capex beneficiary

Thesis: Arista Networks provides the high-speed Ethernet switching and routing backbone for hyperscale AI data centres. Every GPU cluster Nvidia, AMD, or any hyperscaler builds requires Arista's networking layer — it's not a discretionary spend, it's structural. Revenue is compounding at 20%+ with margins expanding.

Why long-term: AI capex drives Arista's order book regardless of which chip architecture wins — they serve MSFT, Meta, Google, and Amazon simultaneously. Zero concentration risk to any single chip platform. Aschenbrenner's infrastructure pivot validates the networking layer specifically.

Spencer's read: ANET at $166 on a +22.45% 1M run is hot but not extended relative to its backlog growth. A structured entry on any 5–10% pullback makes this a clean long-term add with high visibility.

Nick — would you like ANET added to the Long-Term Hold Portfolio as a Core Hold?

11 · Spencer's Cross-Industry Convergence 🧩

🧩 SILVER AS THE INVISIBLE INTERSECTION OF THREE INDEPENDENT THESES

The overlap: Silver is simultaneously (1) a monetary debasement hedge and gold-ratio compression play (Howell/Alden thesis), (2) an industrial metal critical to solar panels and EV batteries (clean energy infrastructure), and (3) a key conductor in AI data centre power distribution and grid expansion. No single thought leader in Nick's coverage holds all three vectors — Howell sees the monetary angle, Aschenbrenner sees the power infrastructure angle, and neither names silver explicitly as the convergence point.

Who would benefit: SLV (direct), SILJ (silver miners ETF), First Majestic Silver (AG), Pan American Silver (PAAS) for mining leverage.

Why it's unappreciated: Monetary analysts don't model industrial demand forecasts; AI infrastructure analysts don't model precious metals supply cycles. Silver lives in the gap between two specialist communities — and the +6.15% this week suggests the market is starting to price the convergence without naming it.

🧩 OKLO / NUCLEAR AS THE ONLY ASSET SERVING BOTH THE DEBASEMENT CAMP AND THE AGI CAMP

The overlap: Uranium and nuclear power sit at the precise intersection of Alden's resource-scarcity / debasement thesis (uranium is a finite, nationally strategic

commodity) and Aschenbrenner's AGI infrastructure thesis (nuclear is the only technology that can provide scalable, dispatchable baseload power for 100MW+ AI data centres). The debasement funds buy URNM as a commodity scarcity play; the AI infrastructure funds buy nuclear PPAs for data centre power security — and neither camp is fully talking to the other.

Who would benefit: URNM (ETF), OKLO (SMR), CCJ (miner), CEG and VST (nuclear-heavy US utilities), NLR (global nuclear ETF).

Why it's unappreciated: Howell and Alden model it as a commodity; Aschenbrenner models it as a capex input. The SMR contract cycle — where a hyperscaler signs a 20-year PPA with an OKLO-type operator — creates a permanent demand signal that neither a commodity model nor a capex model fully captures.

🧩 CHINA PBOC EXPANSION + WEAK DOLLAR = EM COPPER SUPER-CYCLE SETUP BEING MISSED BY CRYPTO-FOCUSED LEADERS

The overlap: Howell explicitly flags that "a weaker dollar and a strong Chinese economy are key for EM outperformance" — his PBOC expansion thesis is a direct tailwind for copper and base metals. Copper is +11.26% over 1M, quietly running while all attention is on gold and BTC. The AI grid buildout (Aschenbrenner's thesis) requires enormous copper volumes — from transformer windings to data centre bus bars. Two independent macro forces (PBOC easing + AI capex) are creating demand for the same physical commodity.

Who would benefit: COPX (copper miners ETF), FCX (Freeport-McMoRan), SCCO (Southern Copper), and indirectly APH (Amphenol — copper-intensive connector systems) and VRT (copper cooling systems). The Hang Seng itself benefits if copper export revenues lift Chinese industrial profits.

Why it's unappreciated: Crypto-first leaders (Pal, Visser, Cowen) don't model base metals; commodity macro leaders (Howell) don't model AI capex demand curves. Copper is being bid from both directions simultaneously and neither camp is owning the narrative.

Easton Assets Market Research · Tuesday 21 April 2026 · Spencer Easton, AI Chief of Staff · Portfolio tracker: Google Drive